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### 4.5.3 Number of locules

Ovary bears ovules on a specialized tissue called **placenta**. A **septum** is a crosswall or partition of ovary. The walls of ovary and septa form a cavity called **locule**.

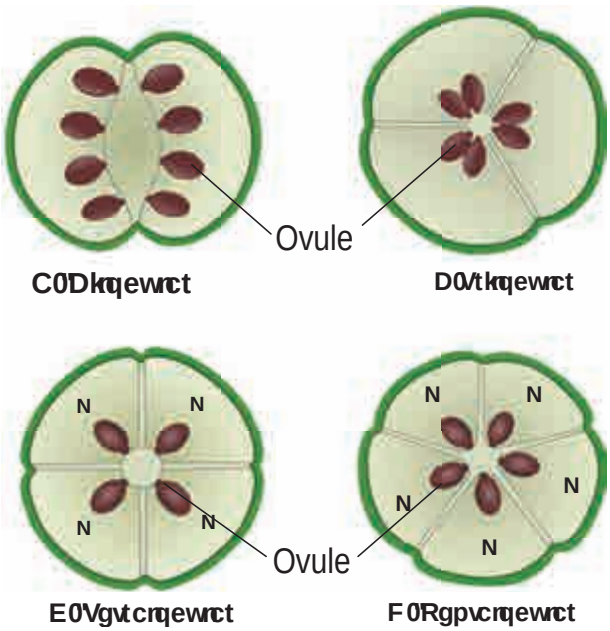



**Figure 4.34:** Locules

*Number of locules*

| Unilocular | Bilocular | Trilocular |
|---|---|---|
| Ovary with one chamber Example: pea, groundnut. | Ovary with two chambers Example: mustard, *Crossandra*. | Ovary with three chambers Example: banana, *Euphorbia*. |

Like that tetralocular and pentalocular ovaries are present according to the locule numbers four and five. More than one locule ovaries are called **plurilocular.**

### 4.5.4 Style and stigma

**1. Style** is a stalk like structure of a pistil connecting ovary and stigma.

**a. Simple**: Single unbranched style. Example: *Hibiscus*.

**b. Bifid**: A style branched into two. Example: Asteraceae

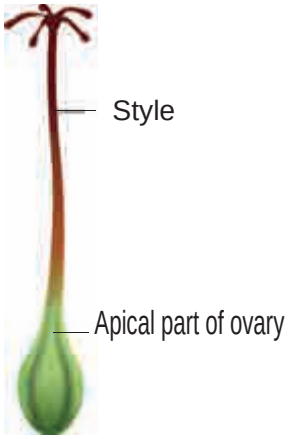



**Figure 4.35: (a)** Simple style



**Figure 4.35: (b)** Bifid style

**c. Gynobasic style**: arising from base of the ovary. Example: Lamiaceae (*Ocimum*), characteristic of Boraginaceae.

**d. Lateral style**: Style arises from the side of ovary. Example: *Mangifera*.

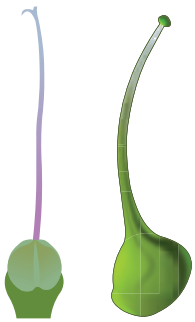


**Figure 4.35: (c)** Gynobasic style, **(d)** Lateral style

**2. Stigma:** A stigma is a structure present at the tip of a pistil which receives the pollen grains.

**a. Discoid:** A disk-shaped stigma is called **discoid**.

**b. Capitate**: Stigma appearing like a head. Example: *Alchemilla*

**c. Globose:** Stigma is spherical in shape is called **globose**.

**d. Plumose stigma**: Stigma feathery which is unbranched or branched as in Asteraceae, Poaceae.

**3. Pistillode**: A reduced sterile pistil. Example: ray floret of head inflorescence in *Helianthus*.